Cambo Health Walks



Hag Stones Walk

CAMBO
gardens | arts | café | shop

Walking Scotland

About our walks

These walks have been developed by the Monday Walking Group which meets at the Cambo Stables each Monday morning at 9.30am, weather permitting.

The group walks are in association with Walking Scotland, a National Walking and Wheeling charity, whose purpose is to encourage walking by providing a framework for organised walking groups.

Walking Scotland use both terms walking and wheeling as it's more inclusive. Both words represent the action of moving at a pedestrian's pace, whether or not someone is unaided or using some kind of wheeled mobility aid.

The Walk Leaders have received appropriate training to ensure the walks are suitable and risk assessed for all attending, including those who use wheeled devices.

The walks are short, safe and social at a pace that we are able to talk.

They last approximately 1 → 1¼ hours and between 1 → 5km in length.

Depending on weather conditions, the paths may be slippery in places.

Cambo Gardens are managed by the Cambo Heritage Trust with its' simple aim for Cambo to be a place 'where people and plants grow'.



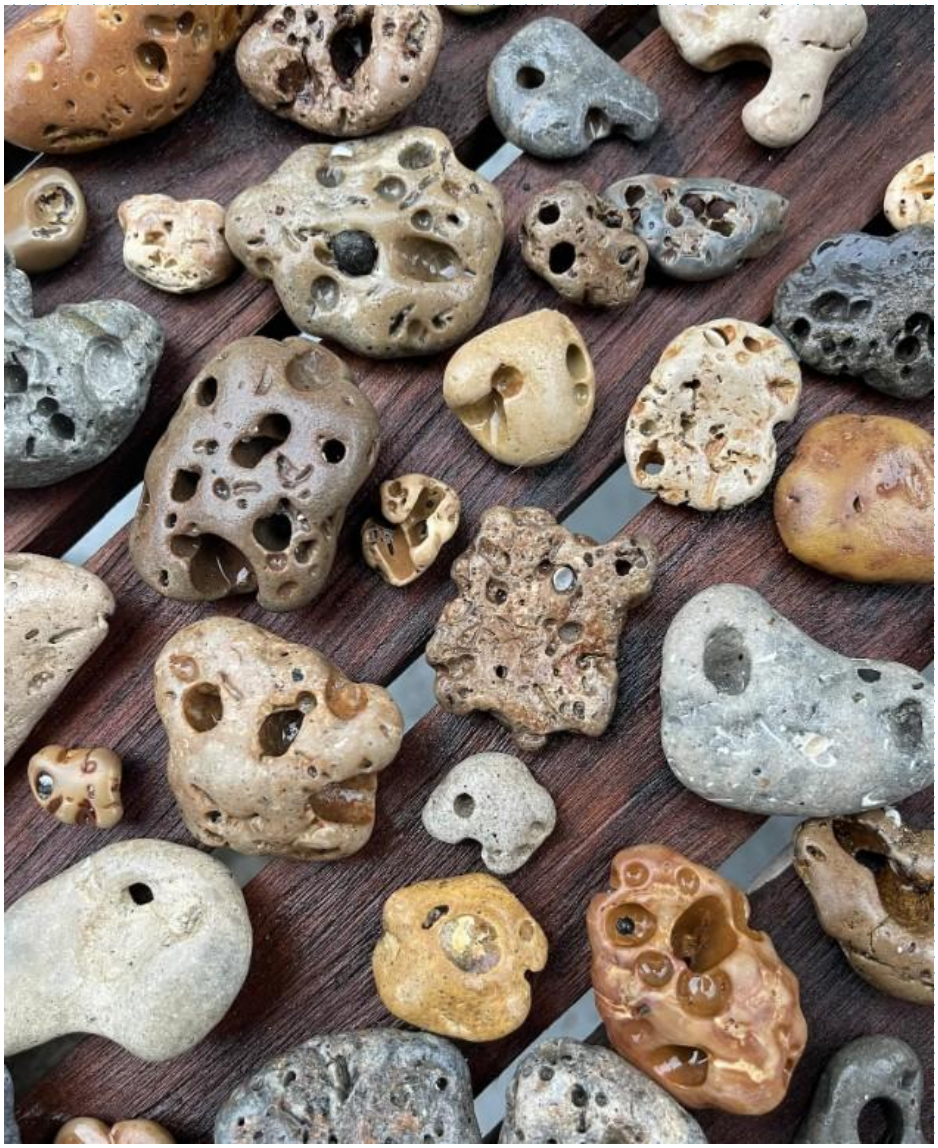
Hag Stones

Hag stones are viewed as protective talismans and objects of enchantment.

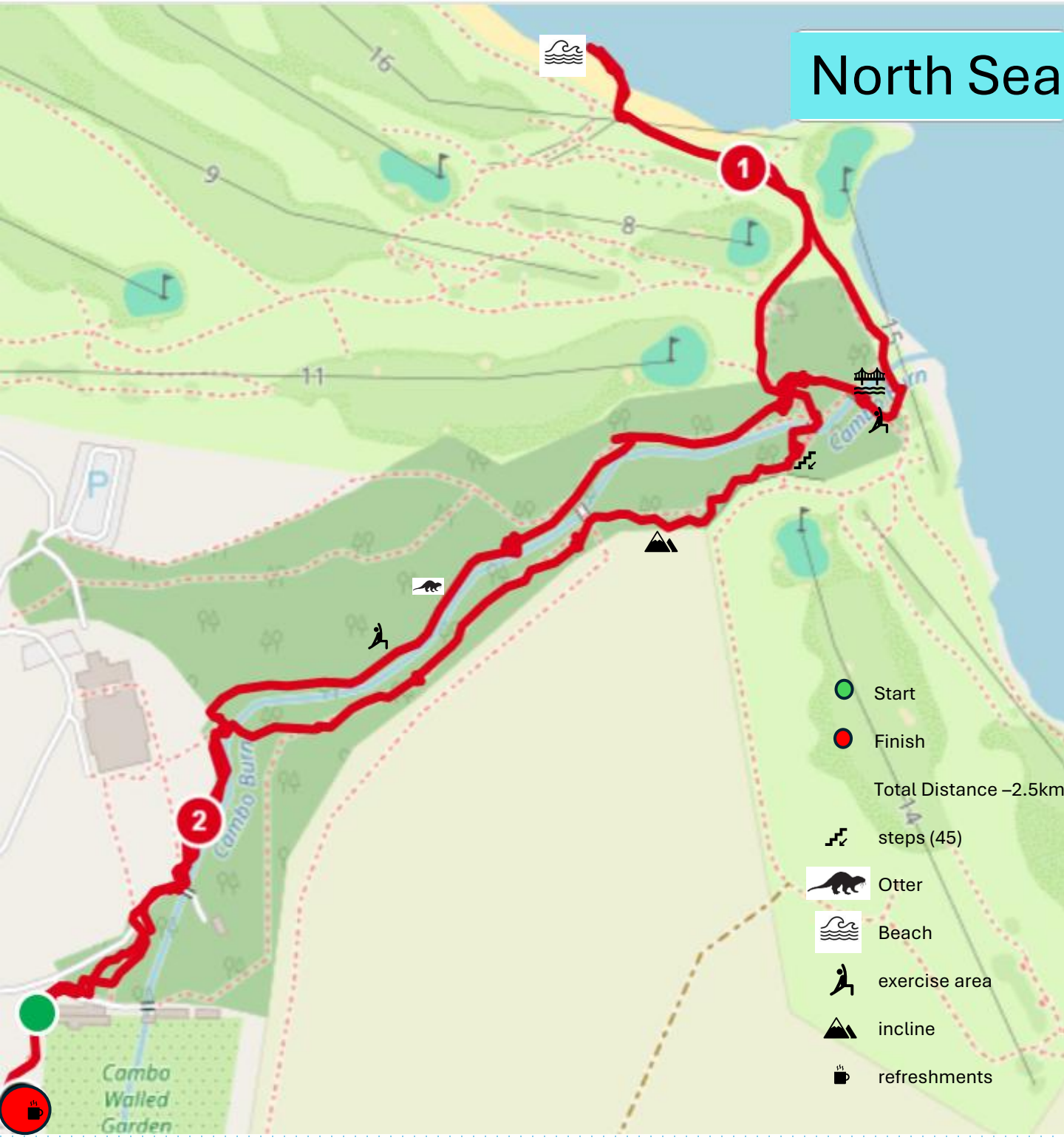
Historically, they were hung over house doors, windows, bedposts, or nailed to stable lintels to block evil spirits, nightmares, and witchcraft.

According to legend, looking through the hole allows a person to see past illusions, spot fairies, gnomes, or disguised magical beings, and peer into the unseen or "fairy realm".

They are also used as wishing stones, carried for personal health, or tied to keys and boats to prevent loss or storms.



Hag Stones Walk



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Hag Stones Walk

General Description:

This walk takes you from the Stables Visitor Centre heading north east, through the Prairie Garden keeping the Cambo Burn on the right we follow the path beyond Cambo House before crossing a bridge, through a wooden gate, then taking the left fork and continuing with the burn on our left.

The path steadily rises as we head towards the sea. Just beyond the crest of the path the 'Three Bridges' come into view followed by 45 steps that descend to the burn.

After crossing the first bridge and passing through the gate, turn right towards the second bridge and, after crossing, turn back across the third bridge. At this point be aware of any golfers playing the 15th hole of Kingsbarns GC. Head along the sandy path towards the Cambo Sands, where a small track leads down a small incline to the area containing Hag Stones.

Returning from the beach, via the small track, take a left turn along the sandy path before reaching a band of trees. The route emerges onto a wider track; bear right along this, passing to the right of the wooden toilets. Beyond these the track enters the woods. Go through the Cambo gate ahead signed for Fife Coastal Path, note the bridge over the Cambo burn but do not cross this, instead turning right up path on the near bank.

Follow this path, keeping the burn to your left, until, with Cambo House on your right, the path reaches a wooden gate.

Turning right the walk ends after we skirt round the north of the Walled Garden, through the Prairie Garden and back around to the Visitor Centre.

Pathway Conditions:

The path is clear and wide enough for a wheeled walking aid. There are some inclines, both down and up, mainly on the outward section, where extra care is necessary, particularly on the downward inclines.

Weather Considerations:

Depending on weather conditions the path may be slippery in places.

Interesting Features:

Hag stones, golf course, look out for the otter holt on the south bank of the burn.

Walk Leader Agreement

*We will always try to make the walk safe for you by doing a risk assessment

*We will describe the route and any hazards to you before we start walking and will let you decide how far you want to walk

*We will try to make sure that all staff and volunteers have done the Walking Scotland Walk Leader training course

*We will try to find a walk that is suitable for everyone

Walking Scotland

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Walker Agreement

* I will only do the walk if I am fit enough. If I have any concerns about this I will talk to a Walk Leader or a health professional

* I will tell a Walk Leader if I feel unwell while out on a walk

* I will let a Walk Leader know if I am leaving the walk before it has ended

* It is up to me to make sure I can do the Health Walk safely

* I understand that I come on a Health Walk at my own risk

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Strength & Balance

THE BACK KNEE STRENGTHENER: 1

Do this one standing in front of a bench or table.

Stand up tall and bend one knee, bringing your foot **slowly** towards your bottom Hold for a low count of 3. Keep the knee of the bent leg slightly behind the knee of the straight leg

Return to the starting position slowly.

Again, try this 5 times on each side at first and build up to 10 times with each leg.



KNEE BENDS: 2

Stand facing the bench or table as before.

Place your feet shoulder width apart. Bend your knees and squat down by about 10cm (4") by bending your knees. Come up and repeat. Keep your back straight and don't let your knees extend over your toes.

This exercise will strengthen the big muscles in your hips and thighs, and will improve your balance. This can help when climbing stairs, walking, or bending to speak to someone.

Try this exercise 5 times and build up to 10 repetitions as you get stronger. You could also hold the squat for a few seconds.



CALF RAISES WITH SUPPORT: 3

Stand facing the bench or table as before.

Hold on and look straight ahead.

Position your feet hip width apart. Slowly and with control come up onto your toes, hold for a slow count of 3 and lower your heels back down.

Repeat this exercise 5 times, building up to 10 or more. As your balance improves, try holding on with just one hand or fingertips.

This exercise strengthens your calf muscles and toe joints. It helps you manage everyday activities such as hanging out washing, or reaching up into high cupboards.



TOE RAISES WITH SUPPORT: 4

Stand tall beside a bench or table.

Hold on and look ahead. Your feet should be hip width apart. Come back onto your heels, raising the front of your feet off the floor, then lower your toes back to the ground. Don't let your body hinge at the hips, keep the body as straight as possible.

Repeat this exercise 5 times and build up to 10 or more. As your balance improves, try holding on with just one hand or fingertips.

This strengthens your lower leg muscles and will make it easier for you to step backwards, or do fun things like push your grandchildren on the swings!



SIDE HIP STRENGTHENER: 5

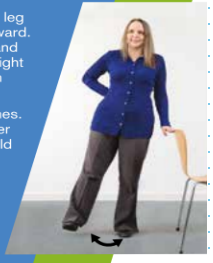
Stand tall beside a bench or table.

Hold on and keep your exercising leg straight, with the foot straight forward. Slowly lift the leg out to the side and return. Try and keep the body upright and only move the leg, rather than swinging over to the side.

Repeat 5 times, build up to 10 times. Swap round and exercise the other leg. Lift the leg out to the side, hold for a slow count of 3 and return.

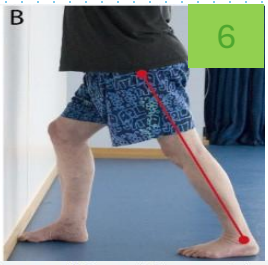
Try to keep the body upright and only move the leg, rather than the top part of your body.

This strengthens your hip muscles and helps you with stepping up over pavements or kerbs.



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A. Place your hands against a wall for stability. Bend the right leg and step the left leg back at least a foot's distance, keeping it straight. Both feet should be flat on the floor.

B. The left calf muscle is stretched by keeping the left leg as straight as possible and the left heel on the floor.

C. Repeat with the opposite leg.

Walking Scotland

Background Information

The Cambo Estate has been in the Erskine family for 300 years and in 1976 Lady Catherine Erskine and her husband Sir Peter took over the estate and began offering volunteering and training opportunities to the local community and opened to the public in the 1980s at snowdrop time when the grounds around the house are carpeted white.

Developing the walled garden was a logical next step in making a garden of interest to visitors all through the year. The head gardener introduced bold planting inspired by the New Perennial Movement* using grasses and late season perennials that didn't need staking or deadheading, achieving high output for low input. In late summer and autumn these plantings reach a peak of beauty and interest as the grasses flower amongst herbaceous perennials including persicaria, asters, eupatorium and sedums.

The garden has entered a new chapter which may include training opportunities, an event space, and a contemporary cutting garden.
*Note: a naturalistic landscape and horticultural design style that mimics wild plant communities like prairies, meadows, and steppes.





